Mark Boyes-Smith

AI Design Leader, Advisor

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**UK-based executive design leader with a background in engineering and AI.
I lead end-to-end experience and build super creative, AI-forward teams.**

PRINCIPLES

Hands-on creative leadership
Setting a high benchmark and building conviction in the direction.

Cross-functional collaboration
The only path to a cohesive end-to-end experience that grows the business.

Design teams have a unique power to inspire
Engaging Product, GTM and customers, and helping teams see the future.

Candor and empathy
Both are essential to cultural and organisational success.

EXPERIENCE

Miro Acquired by Bending Spoons — 2026 – Present

Senior Director, Head of AI Design

- Co-led strategy and operationalisation for the Intelligent Canvas 2.0, the business's most critical initiative, from vision to launch for 100 million users in six months.
- Reimagined the end-to-end Miro experience for the agentic era, including Home, Spaces, search and the canvas, stripping back years of accrued complexity.
- Connected five teams (Surface, Behavior, Context, Harness and AI Trust) and cross-functional BoardGen and evaluation efforts into one experience.
- Moved AI from a chat panel onto the canvas: agents that write directly to the board, agent cursors that show their work, planning mode, skills, and voice.
- Shaped a single foundation for Sidekicks and MCP, so first-party and external agents share the same canvas tools.
- Led a vision-first, code-first design practice, using interactive prototypes and labs explorations to test ideas as working experiences.

hyperexponential Acquired by Guidewire — 2024 – 2026

Senior Director, Head of Design

- Joined as founding designer to establish design and brand at hx.
- Hired and built a product design and brand team.
- Led the company rebrand and a reimagining of the platform experience.
- Led experience design for hx's flagship annual event, where all of this launched.
- hx has since been acquired by Guidewire for $2.1bn.

Miro — 2023 – 2024

Director, Head of Design

- Launched the InVision Freehand experience integration, bringing AI and structured formats to Miro.
- Oversaw 9 teams with a design team of 20, across integrations, search, content management, and solutions and use cases.
- Launched the first Intelligent Canvas at Miro Canvas 2024.

InVision Acquired by Miro 2022 – 2023

VP, Head of Design · Director, Product Design

- Led the design organisation, including insights and brand, and co-led the wider product and technology organisation.
- Scaled 4 multi-level product design teams across the canvas and navigation experience, scale, and enterprise readiness.
- Led design for Freehand's award-winning Intelligent Canvas: strategic vision, narrative, design architecture and solutions packaging.
- Established the brand experience for Freehand, InVision's new brand.
- Executive sponsor for high-touch customer engagements.
- Led major product marketing for the Intelligent Canvas launch, including live webinars, videos and articles.

Anaplan 2018 – 2022

Head of Design Systems · Lead Product Designer

- Established and scaled a multi-disciplinary design system team (design, engineering, content strategy, research and brand) supporting a technology organisation of over 1,000.
- Scaled and co-led a multi-disciplinary product design and research team.
- Co-led the design of an award-winning platform experience for real-time dashboards, reporting and monitoring.
- Delivered end-to-end platform capabilities through the design system for accessibility, content localisation and customisation.
- Led the experience onboarding of a major technology acquisition, Mintigo.
- Led the design strategy for a platform customisation growth initiative that drove 35% user growth over two years.
- Led narrative and creative for major product showcases with the C-suite.

Deloitte 2016 – 2018

Lead Product Designer

Independent Design Consultancy Clients include Sky Sports, EE, Hitachi 2012 – 2015

EDUCATION

University of York 2008 – 2012

BEng Computer Science with Industry

- 1st class dissertation: Manipulating 2D facial features against the 3D reflectance properties of human faces

TALKS & MEDIA

Keynote · Canvas 26: Miro Keynote 2026

Talk · How AI Is Changing the Face of Design 2026

Talk · Diamonds Are Not Forever: How AI Killed the Double Diamond, SXSW London 2026

Podcast · Copilot redesign, is AI ever done, and Miro's Head of AI Design, AI and Design 2026

Podcast · Leading Design and Talent in the Age of AI, Hired to Lead 2026

Keynote · Canvas 24: Intelligent Canvas Keynote 2024

Talk · Leaning Into Design Systems, DIBI Conference 2022